

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 219

Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1950-1961

Coverage Date: 1950-1961

Place Coverage: Nyae Nyae Region, Namibia And Botswana

Section Title(S): Terms Applied To Affines

Figure 3^A shows the primary affines, the terms applied to them, and the joking relationship among them.

602
[Kin Relationships](#)

Secondary Affines. I call "secondary" a group of more remote affines—the parents, offspring, and siblings of ego's primary affines. !Kung families visit each other a great deal, and a person is likely to have close and frequent contact with many of his secondary affines as well as with his primary affines.

602
[Kin Relationships](#)

Secondary affines are:

602
[Kin Relationships](#)

1. Parents and siblings of BrWi, SiHu Offspring of the above siblings
2. Offspring of WiBr, WiSi, HuBr, HuSi
3. Parents and siblings of WiBrWi, WiSiHu, HuBrWi, HuSiHu Offspring of the above siblings
4. Siblings of SoWi, DaHu Offspring of the above siblings

Terms are not fixed in the secondary affinal relationships as they are in the primary affinal relationships. The factor of the name is operative in secondary affinal relationships, and if there were reason for the term to be applied on the basis of the name, this would be done. In all probability, the persons who become ego's secondary affines at the time of his marriage have been, prior to the marriage, ego's name-relatives. If this is the case, as it was for my

602
[Kin Relationships](#)

608
[Artificial Kin Relationships](#)

informants, ego continues to apply to these persons the terms he applied in the name-relationship, adding to these terms either *n!unba* or *n!untai*: that is, *tsu-n!unba*, *//gan!untai*, *!gun!a-n!unba*, *tūn-n!untai*, *!go-n!unba*, *!kwi-n!untai*, and *tsīn!unba* or *tsī-n!untai*.

Although it is strictly correct to use the combined terms for secondary affines, many people drop one or the other part in addressing each other. It is especially common to drop *n!unba* or *n!untai* when addressing children or young persons.

602
Kin Relationships

The name-relationship is so extensive that it is very unlikely that ego's secondary affines would not previously have been his name-relatives. If, however, it were to happen that ego had no term to apply to a secondary affine on the basis of the factor of the name, he could fall back on the generational method and apply a term according to its pattern.

602
Kin Relationships

608
Artificial Kin Relationships

A, [For Fig. 3, see Category 601, p. 220—Analyst]

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu
Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)